

Mass production

Florey's **successful trials** led American drug companies to start producing the drug in large quantities. The first stocks of penicillin were sent to help soldiers wounded in **WORLD WAR II**, and dramatically reduced the number of deaths from infected wounds. After the war, the new drug was in demand to **combat diseases** such as pneumonia, scarlet fever, gangrene, and diphtheria.



Howard Florey worked with drug companies in the US to produce large quantities of penicillin.

Vials of penicillin were packed along with other battlefield medicines to treat wounded soldiers during World War II.



Amazing antivirals

Viruses are different from bacteria. They invade healthy cells and force them to copy the virus so that it spreads. **GERTRUDE B. ELION** was an American chemist who developed the first widely available antiviral drug, **acyclovir**, in the 1970s. It was used to treat the herpes virus, which causes cold sores. She later **came out of retirement** to help create AZT, the first anti-HIV drug.

How it changed the world

The discovery of penicillin saved millions of lives, but it also led to a revolution in the development of new drugs, with many more antibiotics following in its wake. Along with antivirals, these drugs have provided safe treatments for countless conditions.

ELIZABETH LEE HAZEN and RACHEL FULLER BROWN patented the antibiotic **NYSTATIN** in 1957. It is used to fight fungal infections.

